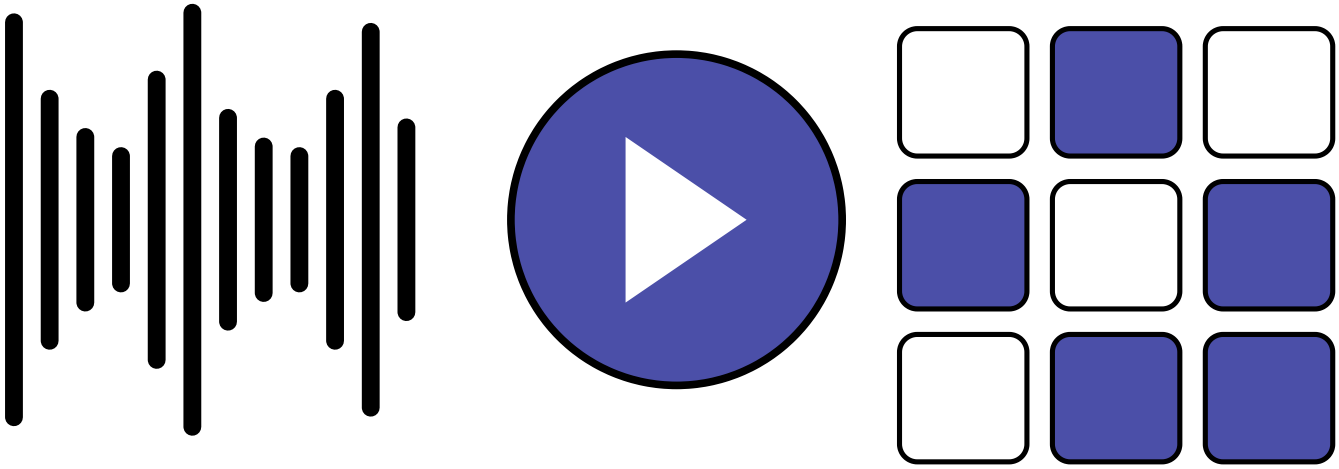
HUDSON BEAT



MAKE MUSIC YOUR WAY
FREE PLAY

DMP2 · open-ended project · proposal · intro slides

GRADES 9–12 · 7 CLASS PERIODS · 22 PAGES + 19-SLIDE DECK

FREE PLAY

How to use this resource

START HERE

Teacher

WHAT THIS IS ·

A 7-class-period open-ended project for high school music technology. Each student picks any style, technique or idea, writes a proposal paragraph, builds the track in Logic, mixes it, bounces it and presents it, with Padlet questions for feedback. It is the project from my Digital Music Production 2 course (focus: creative freedom), and the projects in that course can be taught in any order. My teacher notes call it a diagnostic project as much as a creative one.

QUICK START ·

1. Read the pacing guide (page 5) and my teacher notes (pages 6–7).
2. Set up the Presentation Padlet and the submission spot (page 4).
3. Print the student pages (pages 12–21), one set per student.
4. Open the intro deck and read the speaker notes for Class 1.

THE INTRO DECK ·

Every slide has a class: Class 1 (slides 1–7), Class 2 (slides 8–10), Class 3 (slides 11–12), Class 4 (slides 13–14), Class 6 (slides 15–17) and Class 7 (slides 18–19). Class 5 is a working day with no new slide. Every slide has speaker notes.

Fonts: the deck uses Oswald and Source Sans 3 (free on Google Fonts, built into Google Slides). If PowerPoint or Keynote shows a different font, install the two fonts or present the PDF copy, which shows the intended look.

WHAT'S INSIDE ·

PART	PAGES	USE
Teacher pages	pages 2–11	How to use, overview, setup, pacing, teacher notes, what changed, Logic quick reference, idea starters, worked example
Student pages	pages 12–21	Idea sketchpad, Proposal planner, Work plan, project sheet (3 pages), rubric, vocabulary, feedback planner, reflection
Intro deck (separate file)	deck	19 slides, .pptx + PDF, speaker notes on every slide

NO AUDIO INCLUDED

No audio, video, songs or examples are included. Students make every sound in their tracks themselves, so everything in their projects is their own. For the Class 1 hook, you only ask questions aloud.

MAKE IT FIT YOUR CLASS ·

- **Easier or harder:** my variations on page 6: a short list of prompts to choose from (page 10 has twelve), or a minimum length, original MIDI tracks only, or an artist statement.
- **Feedback board:** my sheets use Padlet for the three questions; any class board works.
- **Any style:** the project is open, so the pages never name a genre; students fill in their own.
- **Grading:** my rubric, /25, the average of the student's and your score (page 18).

IN ONE SENTENCE

Students pick something they care about, write a plan, follow it through the whole production cycle and play the result for the class.

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FREE PLAY

Project overview

OVERVIEW

DMP2 · Open-ended

FROM MY DMP2 PROJECT MENU

Free Play · Open-Ended · Creative Freedom
Explore any style or technique of your choice. Find your artistic voice and set goals for the semester.

WHAT STUDENTS MAKE ·

One finished track in a style of the student's choosing, as long as it feels complete and uses a variety of tracks and instruments, with EQ, panning and volume balanced on every track. They hand in a proposal paragraph, a bounced .mp3 or .wav and the zipped .logicx project, plus a Padlet post with three feedback questions, then play the track and present it.

WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCES ·

This is a diagnostic project as much as a creative one. It lets you see where each student is — their comfort with Logic, their creative instincts, and their ability to manage time independently. It also establishes the proposal and Padlet Q&A workflow they'll use all semester.

STANDARDS ·

Supports the National Core Arts Standards for Music (Music Technology, high school): generating and developing ideas (MU:Cr1.1, MU:Cr2.1), presenting work (MU:Pr6.1) and responding to it (MU:Re7.2).

GOALS ·

- Explore Logic Pro creatively with full artistic freedom
- Develop project management skills through proposals and documentation
- Practice the full production cycle: idea → composition → mix → presentation
- Build confidence in making creative decisions independently

AT A GLANCE ·

Grades	9–12: the second-year course, after a first year of Logic Pro basics
Length	7 class periods: explore, propose, three working days, mix and bounce, present
Software	Logic Pro: instruments, arrangement, mixing with EQ and panning, bounce
You supply	Macs with Logic Pro, headphones, a feedback board, a place to submit files, and speakers if you can
Assessment	My rubric, 5 categories scored 1–5, /25; final grade = average of the student's and the teacher's score (page 18)

BEFORE THEY START

Students should already know how to open a project, add and play instruments, build a beat or chords, and save, bounce and zip in Logic. Nothing new is taught: the quick reference (page 9) shows where each tool lives.

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FREE PLAY

Setup and what to watch

SETUP

Teacher

YOU NEED ·

- **A Mac with Logic Pro** for each student, and **headphones**. Speakers help for the final listen.
- **A place to submit** the proposal paragraph, an .mp3 or .wav and a zipped .logicx project (your class page).
- **The Presentation Padlet**, set up before Class 1 (my resource: this is yours to set up; none is included).
- **A rule about Apple Loops.** My sheets do not forbid them, and my Harder variation asks for none. Decide before Class 1.
- **Printed student pages**, one set each (pages 12–21).

BEFORE CLASS 1 ·

- [ ] Set up the Presentation Padlet in your class page before Class 1.
- [ ] Check that a student computer opens Logic and plays back through headphones.
- [ ] Decide how students will choose: free choice, or a short list from page 10 (my Easier variation).
- [ ] Print the student pages; set up the submission spot for the proposal.

WHAT TO WATCH (MY CLOSING NOTE) ·

This is a diagnostic project. Use it to calibrate your expectations for the group: note who manages time well, who needs more structure, and who might be ready for bigger challenges.

KIT SUGGESTIONS, NOT PART OF MY SHEETS

- While students work, ask three questions: What does it sound like so far? What is the next thing you will add? What would you cut if you ran out of time?
- The Work plan (page 14) shows time management in the students' own words.
- Keep a running list of who needed a nudge and when.

MUSIC THEY DID NOT MAKE ·

A KIT SUGGESTION

If a student recreates a song they like (my Easier variation), they build their own version in Logic. No one else's audio goes into the project, and only the student's own track is bounced and submitted.

KEEP THE VOLUME MODERATE

Tell students to start with the headphones low and to check the final mix at a normal level.

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FREE PLAY

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The "My plan" column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students' hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Introduction, project overview, explore Logic, brainstorm ideas.	Slides 1–7: hook, what Free Play is, the production cycle, step 1, commit early. Hand out the project sheet and the Idea sketchpad. Students open Logic and try sounds.	Slides 1–7	p. 12, p. 15, p. 16, p. 17, p. 19
CLASS 2	**Class 2:** Write and submit project proposals via your class page.	Slides 8–10: the three parts of a proposal, vague or clear, before you submit. Hand out the Proposal planner. Read each proposal before the student builds.	Slides 8–10	p. 13
CLASS 3	**Classes 3–5:** Working days — compose, build, refine.	Slides 11–12: steps 3 and 4, and the worked example on paper. Hand out the Work plan. Then work time.	Slides 11–12	p. 14
CLASS 4		Slides 13–14: keep building, and mix time is not optional. Then work time.	Slides 13–14	p. 14
CLASS 5		Full working day: compose, build, refine. Ask each student to play you the track so far and say what is next.	No new slides	—
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final mix, bounce, and prepare presentations. Students write their 3 Padlet feedback questions.	Slides 15–17: mix and finalize, what to turn in, the rubric. Students self-score and post their three questions.	Slides 15–17	p. 18, p. 20
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 18–19: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate's questions. Reflection (page 21) follows the presentations.	Slides 18–19	p. 20, p. 21

THE ONE RULE FOR CLASS 2

Read every proposal before the student starts building. A one-sentence proposal goes back with a question (what will it sound like? which tools?), not a grade. The Proposal planner (page 13) has the frame.

CLASSES 3–5

Working days. Class 5 has no new slide. Circulate and use this project as a diagnostic: note who manages time, who needs structure and who is ready for more (my closing note).

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FREE PLAY

Teacher notes · the big idea

WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCES ·

This is a diagnostic project as much as a creative one. It lets you see where each student is — their comfort with Logic, their creative instincts, and their ability to manage time independently. It also establishes the proposal and Padlet Q&A workflow they'll use all semester.

COMMON STUDENT STRUGGLES ·

- Analysis paralysis — students freeze because they have too many choices. Encourage them to commit to an idea early and iterate.
- Weak proposals — some students write one vague sentence. Push them to describe what their track will sound like and which tools they'll use.
- Poor time management — students underestimate how long mixing takes. Remind them to leave at least one full class for final mixing and bounce.
- Students treat the presentation Q&A as an afterthought — remind them that thoughtful questions lead to better feedback.

SUGGESTED VARIATIONS ·

Easier: Provide a list of 3–5 project prompts they can choose from (e.g., "make a 30-second intro for a podcast," "recreate a song you like") to reduce overwhelm.

More Advanced: Require a minimum track length (2+ minutes), a specific number of original MIDI tracks (no Apple Loops), or a written artist statement explaining their creative choices.

WHERE THIS KIT HELPS WITH EACH STRUGGLE

- Analysis paralysis: the Idea starters (page 10) and the Idea sketchpad (page 12).
- Weak proposals: the Proposal planner (page 13) and the worked example (page 11).
- Time management: the Work plan (page 14) and slide 14, which protects mix time.
- Q&A as an afterthought: the presentation planner (page 20) has students write the three questions early.

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SUGGESTED RESOURCES ·

MY LIST	IN THIS KIT
No specific tutorials needed — this is about student exploration	Kept as I wrote it. The kit adds no tutorial and no video: the Logic quick reference (page 9) only says where each tool lives.
Consider playing 2–3 examples of past student work to set expectations	No student work is included, so there is nothing to play. This kit gives an invented example on paper instead (page 11): a proposal, an arrangement map and a mix plan for a piece that does not exist, so you can show what a finished plan looks like without using anyone's work.
Set up the Presentation Padlet in your class page before Day 1	Kept, and added to the setup checklist (page 4). The Padlet is yours to set up: no board or link is included.

HOW TO GRADE ·

- My rubric: five categories, each scored 1–5, /25 (page 18). Students score themselves first; the final grade is the average of their score and yours.

Suggestions from this kit, not part of my rubric:

- Creativity & Originality: ask what the student was going for in the proposal, then listen for it. Defaults and clichés are fine as a start; the question is what they changed.
- Technical Skill: open the project. Which Logic tools did they use, and are EQ, panning and volume set on every track (my third requirement)?
- Composition & Structure: compare the arrangement with the Work plan (page 14). Does the piece feel complete, with sections that change?
- Sound Design & Mix Quality: listen on headphones and on speakers (my fourth tip). Ask which part leads in each section.
- Documentation & Presentation: the proposal, the Work plan, the three Padlet questions and the Reflection page (page 21) are the evidence.

REFLECTION · ADDED BY THIS KIT ·

The rubric mentions reflection, but the project sheet has no reflection task, so this kit adds one (page 21): a written or oral conversation about how you did on the project and what you would do differently next time. Students write it or talk it through with you; either way they answer the four prompts. Allow about 10 minutes after the presentations. It adds no points and no rubric row; use it as evidence when you score Documentation & Presentation.

NOTES / OBSERVATIONS ·

Use this project to calibrate your expectations for the group. Take note of who manages time well, who needs more structure, and who might be ready for bigger challenges.

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FREE PLAY

What changed from the original

CHANGES

Teacher

This kit is built from three of my documents: the **Project Sheet & Rubric**, the **Teacher Notes** and the **Free Play** entry on my DMP2 project menu. This page lists every change to my wording, so you know exactly what is mine and what was added.

WORDING CHANGES ·

- My LMS name is written as “your class page” (requirement 4, step 2, checklist items 1 to 3, my Class 2 pacing line and the Presentation Padlet resource).
- In that resource, “Day 1” is written “Class 1” on the setup page; on page 7 it stays as I wrote it.
- Page numbers are added to steps 1 to 3 (the Idea sketchpad, Proposal planner and Work plan).
- My resource “Consider playing 2–3 examples of past student work” is listed as I wrote it. No student work is included; the kit adds an invented worked example on paper beside it (page 11).
- My pacing guide’s “Classes 3–5” row spans the Class 3, 4 and 5 rows, so each class can name its slides.
- Layout only: the rubric’s Name and Date lines moved to the top; its Notes box became ruled lines; the arrows in goal 3 are drawn.
- The intro deck shortens my wording (full wording on pages 15–17): slide 3 shortens my overview and a goal, slide 6 shortens step 1, slide 7 shortens tips 1, 2 and 3, slides 8 and 10 shorten step 2 and my second struggle, slide 11 shortens steps 3 and 4, slide 14 shortens requirement 3, my third struggle and tip 4, slide 15 shortens steps 5 and 6, slide 16 shortens the submission checklist, and slide 18 shortens step 7.
- **Reflection added (page 21).** My rubric mentions reflection, but the project sheet has no reflection task. This kit adds one, following my definition: a written or oral conversation about how the student did on the project and what they would do differently next time. It adds no points and no rubric row.

KEPT AS I WROTE IT ·

Everything else from my three documents is kept as I wrote it: the overview, the four goals, the four vocabulary terms, the four requirements (apart from the class page), steps (apart from the page numbers), tips, checklist and file name (“Your Name – Free Play”), the rubric (five categories scored 1–5, /25, the average of the student’s and the teacher’s score), what the project reinforces, the four common struggles, the variations, my three resources, my day-by-day pacing and my closing note, and the project menu entry quoted on page 3. No rubric row is added and the requirements are unchanged.

NEW IN THIS KIT ·

Everything else is new and supports my sheets without changing them: how to use the kit, the overview and setup pages, the teacher moves and slide numbers in the pacing guide, the grading suggestions, the Logic quick reference, the Idea starters page (prompts for my Easier variation, and my Harder variation laid out), the worked example (an invented 2-minute-30 piece on paper, not audio), the Idea sketchpad, Proposal planner and Work plan, the vocabulary page, the presentation planner and the intro deck. None of these adds a requirement or a rubric row. The one addition that asks something of students is the Reflection page (page 21), explained under Wording changes; the rubric is unchanged.

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FREE PLAY

Logic quick reference

SETUP

Teacher + student

Where to find the tools a Free Play project is likely to use. Demonstrate what your class needs on Classes 1 and 3 and then let students work. Names are from current Logic Pro versions; check the labels on yours.

New project and tracks	File › New…, then add tracks with Track › New Tracks…: a Software Instrument track for MIDI sounds, an Audio track for recordings, a drum track for beats.
Play and record MIDI	Use a MIDI keyboard, or turn on Musical Typing (Command-K) to play from the computer keyboard. Arm the track and press Record (R).
Apple Loops	Open the Loop Browser (O) to find ready-made loops. My Harder variation asks for original MIDI tracks and no Apple Loops, so decide your rule before Class 1.
Arrangement	Copy and paste regions to build sections, and name and color them so every section is easy to see. Sketch the whole form first, then fill it in.
Mixer: volume and panning	Press X to open the Mixer. Move each track's fader for volume and its Pan knob to place it left or right.
EQ	Add Channel EQ to the channel strip. Cut what you do not need before you boost anything, and check the result with the track soloed and in the full mix.
Effects	Insert effects on the channel strip, for example a reverb or a delay, and keep them subtle until the rest of the mix is balanced.
Transitions	A reverse sound, a riser, a drop out or a filter sweep can join two sections. Draw it with automation or build it from a sound.
Automation	Press A to show automation, choose a parameter such as volume or a filter, and draw changes over time.
Save versions	Use File › Save As… with a numbered name before each big change.
Bounce and zip	File › Bounce › Project or Section (Command-B), MP3 or WAV. In Finder, Control-click the .logicx and choose Compress.

VERSION NOTE

Menu names are from current Logic Pro versions; older versions may differ slightly. Logic Pro is a trademark of Apple Inc., named only to describe what the project needs. This resource is not affiliated with Apple.

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FREE PLAY

Idea starters and my Harder variation

TEACHER

Easier + Harder

My Easier variation is a list of 3–5 prompts students can choose from, to reduce overwhelm. Twelve prompts you can cut down to a short list. Two are my own examples; the rest are kit suggestions. None is a requirement.

TWELVE STARTER PROMPTS (KIT SUGGESTIONS) ·

MAKE SOMETHING FOR SOMETHING

- a 30-second intro for a podcast (my example)
- a theme for a board game that does not exist yet
- a background loop for a study session

MAKE SOMETHING IN A STYLE

- a track in a style you rarely make
- a slow beat with a simple melody on top
- a build that grows for a minute, then drops out

MAKE SOMETHING WITH A RULE

- only three instruments
- every section is different from the one before
- a track that could not exist without its first sound

MAKE SOMETHING FROM SOMETHING YOU LIKE

- recreate a song you like (my example): make your own version
- take what you notice in music you like and use it in a new piece
- change one choice (tempo, instrument or mood) and see what happens

MY HARDER VARIATION, LAID OUT ·

MY OPTION	HOW TO USE IT
Minimum track length	2+ minutes. The worked example (page 11) is 2:30, so you can show what that looks like in sections.
Original MIDI tracks	A set number, with no Apple Loops. Tell students the number on Class 1.
Artist statement	A written statement explaining their creative choices. It adds to the Reflection page (page 21); it does not add a rubric row.

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE

Pick 3–5 prompts, put them on the board on Class 1 and let students choose one or write their own. Free Play stays free: a student may ignore the list. The Idea sketchpad (page 12) is where they write down what they pick.

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FREE PLAY

Worked example · an invented piece

EXAMPLE

Teacher

An **invented piece, "Late Bus Home", described on paper**: no audio is included, so the numbers are easy to check. Students' projects will differ.

1 · A VAGUE PROPOSAL

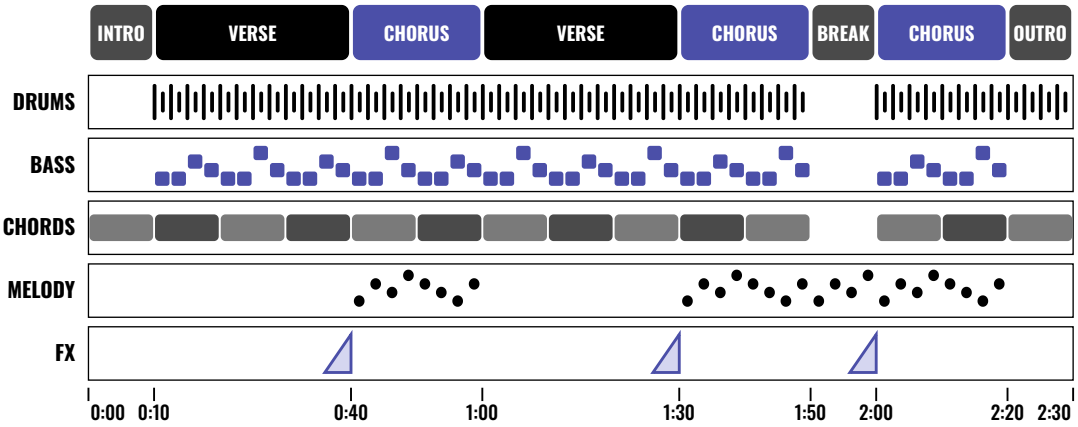
I will make a chill beat.

Nobody can say what it sounds like or which tools it needs.

2 · A CLEAR PROPOSAL (CONCEPT, TOOLS, SOUND)

I am making "Late Bus Home", a mellow instrumental about the ride home after a long day, about two and a half minutes long. I will start with a slow drum groove and a soft bass, add warm chords on a keyboard sound, and write a simple melody for the choruses. In Logic I will use drum sounds and software instruments, EQ to keep the bass from covering the chords, and panning to spread the parts out. It will sound relaxed and a little sleepy at 96 beats per minute, and it should get fuller each time the chorus comes back.

3 · THE ARRANGEMENT MAP: 2:30 ·



4 · CHECKING THE NUMBERS, AND WHY IT WORKS

96 beats per minute is 0.625 s a beat, so a bar of 4/4 is 2.5 s. Sections: 4 + 12 + 8 + 12 + 8 + 4 + 8 + 4 = 60 bars, and 60 × 2.5 s = 150 s = 2:30, as the proposal says. Every section has a job and something changes each time: layers enter, the melody arrives in the choruses, a riser leads into each chorus and the break strips the track back.

5 · A MIX PLAN: EQ, PANNING AND VOLUME ON EVERY TRACK ·

TRACK	VOLUME	PANNING	EQ
Drums	steady, under the melody in the choruses	center	cut a little of the muddy low-mids
Bass	just under the drums	center	roll off the highs so it stays out of the chords' way
Chords	softer than the melody	a little left and right	cut the lows so the bass has room
Melody	the loudest part in the choruses	center	lift the upper mids so it cuts through
FX	very quiet	wide	cut the lows so the risers stay light

6 · Three Padlet questions (invented): 1. Where did you first hear the track get fuller? 2. Which part would you turn up or down, and why? 3. Does the title match the way the track feels?

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FREE PLAY

Idea sketchpad

STUDENT

Class 1

Name _____ Date _____

Step 1: open Logic, experiment with sounds, and brainstorm ideas. Write down two or three ideas, not just one, then pick one before the end of class. You can change it later; you cannot start without one.

Styles or sounds I keep coming back to: _____

Three words for the mood I want: _____

Something I want to try in Logic: _____

IDEA	WHAT IT IS, IN ONE OR TWO LINES	CAN I FINISH IT IN 7 CLASSES? WHY?
A		
B		
C		

COMMIT

I am making: _____

I will start with (a sound, a beat, a chord): _____

One thing that could go wrong, and my plan for it: _____

STUCK? (TIPS 2 AND 3 FROM MY PROJECT SHEET)

Do not spend three days picking sounds: get something down early and refine as you go. If you are stuck, listen to music that inspires you, notice what they did and try something similar in your own project.

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FREE PLAY

Proposal planner

STUDENT

Class 2

Name _____ Date _____

Step 2: write a paragraph describing your concept, tools, and what the final product will sound like. Submit it on your class page. Use the frames to start; change them to sound like you.

PART	START WITH	MY ANSWER
Concept	I am making…, about… long, in a style that…	
Tools	In Logic I will use… (instruments, drums, EQ, panning, FX)	
Sound	It will sound… at about… beats per minute, and it will…	

MY PROPOSAL PARAGRAPH ·

BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

- ☐ It says what I am making (the concept)
- ☐ It names the Logic tools I will use
- ☐ It says what the final product will sound like
- ☐ It is a paragraph, not one sentence
- ☐ I submitted it on our class page

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FREE PLAY

Work plan

STUDENT

Classes 3–5

Name _____ Date _____

Steps 3 and 4: lay down your foundation and shape your arrangement, then add layers, melodies, FX and transitions. Before each class write what you plan to finish; after it, what you actually did.

CLASS	FIXED BY THE SCHEDULE	WHAT I PLAN TO FINISH	WHAT I ACTUALLY FINISHED
Class 1	Explore and brainstorm; pick an idea		
Class 2	Proposal submitted		
Class 3			
Class 4			
Class 5			
Class 6	Final mix, bounce; write 3 Padlet questions		
Class 7	Present; answer 2 questions		

PROTECT YOUR MIX TIME

Students underestimate how long mixing takes. Leave at least one full class for final mixing and bounce.

I will start mixing in Class _____ **because** _____

The part of my track I am proudest of so far: _____

The part that is not working yet: _____

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Name _____ Date _____

FREE PLAY

Digital Music Production | *Open-Ended Project* | 7 class periods

OVERVIEW ·

This is your chance to make whatever you want. Use Logic Pro to explore any style, technique, or idea that excites you. The only rule: have a plan and follow through. This project is about finding your creative voice and showing that you can manage a project from start to finish.

GOALS ·

- Explore Logic Pro creatively with full artistic freedom
- Develop project management skills through proposals and documentation
- Practice the full production cycle: idea → composition → mix → presentation
- Build confidence in making creative decisions independently

KEY VOCABULARY ·

DAW	Digital Audio Workstation — the software you use to make music (Logic Pro)
Bounce / Export	Rendering your project into a playable audio file (.mp3 or .wav)
Arrangement	How you organize different sections and instruments across time in your project
Project Proposal	A written plan describing what you intend to create and how

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FREE PLAY

Project sheet · requirements and steps

STUDENT

Name _____ Date _____

REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Length is up to you — but your track should feel complete, not unfinished
- ☐ Use a variety of tracks and instruments appropriate to your chosen style
- ☐ Apply basic mixing: EQ, panning, and volume balancing on all tracks
- ☐ Write a project proposal paragraph (submitted via your class page)

STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Explore** — Open Logic, experiment with sounds, and brainstorm ideas (Idea sketchpad: page 12)
2. **Propose** — Write a paragraph describing your concept, tools, and what the final product will sound like. Submit via your class page (Proposal planner: page 13)
3. **Build** — Lay down your foundation (drums, chords, bass) and begin shaping your arrangement (Work plan: page 14)
4. **Develop** — Add layers, melodies, FX, and transitions. Refine your sound and structure
5. **Mix** — Balance your levels, apply EQ and panning, and clean up your project
6. **Finalize** — Bounce your final track and prepare your presentation
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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FREE PLAY

STUDENT

Project sheet · tips and checklist

Name _____ Date _____

TIPS FOR SUCCESS ·

- Start with a clear idea, but don't be afraid to let it evolve. Some of the best projects shift direction during the process.
- Don't spend 3 days picking sounds. Get something down early and refine as you go.
- If you get stuck, listen to music that inspires you. Pay attention to what they did and try something similar in your own project.
- Listen to your track on headphones AND speakers before you call it done.

SUBMISSION CHECKLIST ·

- ☐ Project proposal paragraph submitted via your class page
- ☐ Bounced .mp3 or .wav uploaded to your class page
- ☐ Zipped .logicx project file uploaded to your class page
- ☐ Files named correctly: "Your Name – Free Play"
- ☐ Padlet post created with your 3 feedback questions
- ☐ Answered at least 2 questions on classmates' Padlet posts during presentations

NOTES ·

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FREE PLAY

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Free Play | Open-Ended Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

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FREE PLAY

Key vocabulary

STUDENT

Vocabulary

Name _____ Date _____

The four words from your project sheet, with my definitions. Rewrite each in your own words, then show where it happens in your own project.

DAW — Digital Audio Workstation — the software you use to make music (Logic Pro)

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my project: _____

BOUNCE / EXPORT — Rendering your project into a playable audio file (.mp3 or .wav)

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my project: _____

ARRANGEMENT — How you organize different sections and instruments across time in your project

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my project: _____

PROJECT PROPOSAL — A written plan describing what you intend to create and how

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my project: _____

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Present and get feedback

STUDENT

Classes 6–7

Name _____ Date _____

FROM YOUR PROJECT SHEET, STEP 7

Present & Get Feedback — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

MY THREE FEEDBACK QUESTIONS ·

Ask about things you really want to know, not yes-or-no questions.

Question 1: _____

Question 2: _____

Question 3: _____

CLASSMATES' QUESTIONS I ANSWERED (AT LEAST 2) ·

CLASSMATE	THEIR QUESTION	MY ANSWER

BEFORE I PRESENT ·

- ☐ Files named "Your Name – Free Play"; proposal, .mp3 or .wav and zipped .logicx submitted
- ☐ Padlet post created with my 3 questions
- ☐ Rubric self-score done (page 18)

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Reflection · how did it go?

STUDENT

After presenting

Name _____ Date _____

WHAT A REFLECTION IS

A reflection is a written or oral conversation about how you did on the project and what you would do differently next time. Answer all four prompts in your own words. You choose how.

☐ **Written.** I will write my answers on this page.

☐ **Oral.** I will talk my answers through with my teacher. My teacher fills in the box at the bottom.

1 **What went well?** Name something in your project you are proud of, and say why it worked.

2 **What did you struggle with?** Say what was hard and what you tried to fix it.

3 **What would you do differently next time?** Be specific: a step, a choice, a sound or a tool.

4 **Look at the rubric (page 18).** Which category are you proudest of, and which would you work on first next time?

ORAL REFLECTION · TEACHER

Date: _____ **Prompts covered (1-4):** _____

Key points I heard: _____

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QUESTIONS?

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CREDITS

- Project sheet, rubric, teacher notes and intro deck: original work by Brian Lotze, Hudson Beat.
- Worked example (an invented 2-minute-30 piece described on paper), the production cycle, proposal and arrangement-map drawings and layouts: original work, Hudson Beat.
- No audio, video, lyrics, album art, screenshots, presets or chart data are included. No student work is included. Padlet is named only as an example of a tool you may already use.
- Text fonts: Oswald (The Oswald Project Authors) and Source Sans 3 (Adobe), SIL Open Font License 1.1.
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Designed with the help of digital and AI tools, and checked by hand.